Skills Summary

Counting On to Compare Two Sets

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Counting on. You do not have to start at one. If you already know one group holds 5 (a full row) or 10 (a full frame), start there and say the next numbers as you touch the extra things.

The last number you say tells how many.

To compare, finish both counts first. Then $>$ means *is greater than* and $<$ means *is less than*. The open end always faces the bigger number. If the two counts are the same number, write $=$.

1. Count on to find how many

Say the number of the group you already know. Then touch each extra thing and say the *next* number. Do not go back to one — going back to one is what makes children lose count.

Example: A full row holds 5 acorns. There are 2 more beside it. How many acorns?
Step 1. The row is full, so its count is already known and only the loose acorns still need touching.
Step 2. Start at five and count on: "six, seven". That is 5 and 2 more.
The last number said is **7** acorns.

Try it: A full ten-frame holds 10 beads. There are 3 more beside it. How many beads?

check: 13

2. Compare two sets

Count set one. Count set two. *Then* decide. A set that is spread out, or drawn in a longer row, is not always the bigger one — only the two numbers can settle it.

Example: Ann has 4 shells and then 3 more. Ben has 5 shells and then 1 more. Write $>$ or $<$ between them.
Step 1. Nothing can be compared until each child's set has one number, so count each set on to the end first.
Step 2. Ann: four, then "five, six, seven". Ben: five, then "six". Seven is more than six.
Ann's set is greater: Ann $>$ Ben.

Try it: Jar A is a full ten-frame and 2 more. Jar B is a full ten-frame and 6 more. Write $>$ or $<$: Jar A ____ Jar B.

check: $<$

3. Find how many more

Start at the **smaller** number. Count on until you reach the bigger number. The answer is how many number *words* you said — the starting number is not one of them.

Example: Kim has 5 marbles. Joe has 8 marbles. How many more does Joe have?
Step 1. This asks how far apart the two counts are, so counting on from the smaller one up to the bigger one answers it without any subtracting.
Step 2. Start at five: "six, seven, eight". Three number words were said.
Joe has **3** more marbles.

Try it: Tam has 7 stickers. Ros has 12 stickers. How many more does Ros have?

check: **5**

(!) Watch out: when you count on for "how many more", do not say the starting number as one of the extras — from five to eight is "six, seven, eight", which is three, not four. And a longer row is not proof: count both sets all the way before you write $>$ or $<$.